

NARENDRAKUMAR NAGARAJAN

Data Engineering Manager | Data Platform Manager | Data & AI Engineering Manager |

mail2naren887@gmail.com | Canada | www.linkedin.com/in/naren887 | Portfolio: <https://narendra-data.streamlit.app/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data and AI Engineering Leader with **15+ years** building and scaling **enterprise data platforms**, **AI-enabled analytics**, and **security-first automation** for **Microsoft** organizations. Proven **people manager** and **engineering execution** leader with experience managing up to **12 engineers**, running **Agile delivery**, and owning **technical governance** through **architecture reviews**, **PR approvals**, and **code reviews**. Deep expertise across **Microsoft Fabric**, **Azure Databricks**, **Synapse**, **ADLS Gen2**, **ADF**, **Kusto**, **Cosmos DB**, **Power BI**, and **secure engineering practices** including **Microsoft Secure Future Initiative (SFI)**, **threat modeling**, **secrets hygiene**, **tenant isolation**, and **network hardening**. Delivered **\$390K+/year cloud savings**, executed **zero-downtime migrations (100+ pipelines)**, and supported platforms processing **50B+ events/month**.

CORE LEADERSHIP STRENGTHS

- **Engineering Management:** people management, matrix leadership, sprint planning, backlog management, prioritization, capacity planning, stakeholder management, cross-functional leadership, escalation management
- **Program/Delivery:** roadmaps, OKRs/KPIs, RAID, dependency management, release readiness (Go/No-Go), Agile (Scrum/Kanban), executive communication, vendor governance
- **Data Governance & Security:** Databricks Unity Catalog, Microsoft Purview, SFI compliance, PII protection, and Zero Trust data access patterns.
- **Operational Excellence:** Managing Data SLAs/SLOs, Data Quality (DQ) frameworks, and incident response for critical pipelines.
- **FinOps & Cloud Efficiency:** Optimizing Spark/Compute clusters, storage lifecycle management, and reducing unit cost of data.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Modern Data Stack:** Microsoft Fabric, Azure Databricks (Spark), Synapse Analytics, ADLS Gen2, Snowflake, Cosmos DB, Logic Apps, Azure Functions, REST APIs, Power BI.
- **Data Engineering:** Python, PySpark, SQL (T-SQL, KQL), C#, Delta Lake, Medallion Architecture (Bronze/Silver/Gold), Event Hubs.
- **GenAI & LLMOps:** Azure AI Foundry, Semantic Kernel, RAG Patterns, Vector Databases, Copilot Studio.
- **DataOps & DevOps:** CI/CD for Data (Azure DevOps), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), Data Quality Testing.
- **Learning & Experimenting:** Model Context Protocol (MCP), Agent-to-Agent (A2A) Orchestration, Multi-Agent Systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

INFOSYS LIMITED - Technology Lead (Client-facing Data Platform / Engineering Manager) | Canada

May 2019 - Present

Engineering Management & Technical Governance (across Microsoft engagements)

- Managed and mentored 8 Infosys Data Engineers (2019-2024); owned sprint planning, task assignment, execution tracking, and delivery accountability across multiple workstreams.
- Currently lead 7 direct-report Infosys Data Engineers and drive matrix execution for 5 Microsoft FTEs to ensure aligned priorities, predictable sprint outcomes, and production-grade delivery.
- Run Agile ceremonies (standups, planning, grooming, reviews, retros) and enforce execution rigor via RAID, dependency management, and release readiness.
- Set engineering quality bar through architecture reviews, PR approvals, and code reviews; drive automation tools and delivery accelerators to improve reliability and reduce operational effort.

Client: Microsoft Cyber Defense Engineering | Engineering Delivery Lead (ARIS / CDE Data Platform)

Sep 2025 - Present

- Lead end-to-end delivery and production readiness for ARIS (Automated Response and Investigation System) platform using Microsoft Foundry, Logic Apps, Synapse, ADLS Gen2, and Kusto.
- Partner with Engineering, Operations, and Security to align platform releases with incident response requirements and high availability standards.
- Own roadmap milestones, dependencies, and risks to maintain zero-downtime operations for mission-critical workflows.
- Enforced SFI-aligned practices across deliverables; drove Cred Scan enhancements improving credential hygiene across storage accounts and platform components.

Client: Microsoft Gaming | Engineering Execution Lead (Security / SFI)

Sep 2024 - Aug 2025

- Built and executed SFI roadmap and achieved 100% SFI compliance across all 6 pillars for Gaming Data Engineering, Data Science, and Services teams.
- Led threat modeling and security assessments; standardized secure architecture patterns to reduce risk exposure and accelerate remediation.
- Implemented/enforced secrets hygiene, cross-tenant authentication best practices, and network hardening (NSG/NSP) with vulnerability management processes.
- Drove stakeholder prioritization and KPI closure through structured governance sessions with 50+ stakeholders.

Client: Microsoft Customer Experience & Success | Data Platform Lead / Product Manager

May 2019 - Aug 2024

- Architected and scaled enterprise Azure data platform using Medallion architecture with ADF, Databricks, ADLS Gen2, Synapse, Cosmos DB, Event Hubs, Logic Apps, Azure Functions, REST APIs.
- Delivered telemetry and analytics platform processing 50B+ events/month across global support channels with strong reliability and stakeholder adoption.
- Designed a metadata-driven ingestion framework automating onboarding and scaling ingestion with consistent patterns and governance.
- Implemented GDPR compliance controls for privacy, access governance, and data retention across global datasets.
- Engineered a data-driven framework defining knowledge context recipes to improve Copilot grounding, relevance, and citation quality.
- Increased productivity by 35% for 500+ global support teams through intelligent recommendations and standardized context delivery.
- Owned Databricks efficiency initiatives (cluster policy, scheduling, performance tuning, PySpark optimization) delivering \$20K+/month savings (\$240K/year).
- Reduced infrastructure spending by 40% through rightsizing, automation, and continuous cost governance.
- Led migration to Microsoft Fabric, transitioning 100+ pipelines with zero downtime.
- Achieved 40% performance improvement and reduced maintenance overhead through modernization and standardization.
- Built automated monitoring and remediation workflows reducing manual intervention by 80% and improving platform reliability.
- Implemented CI/CD with Azure DevOps, reducing manual release effort by ~16 hours/week and improving deployment consistency.

INFOSYS LIMITED - Technology Lead | Chennai, India

Aug 2016 - Apr 2019

Client: Microsoft Customer Experience & Success - Data Platform Lead / Architect

- Led Commercial Data Platform and reporting solutions using ADF, SSIS, SSAS, SQL Server, Power BI, including datamarts, tabular models, NRT pipelines, and reporting layers.
- Architected and led on-prem to Azure migration for BI solution, saving \$150K/year and improving real-time business matching and responsiveness.
- Designed logical data models for 150+ entities and delivered 40+ Power BI dashboards for 500+ stakeholders; built stored procedures and SSIS/SSRS solutions.

ACCENTURE - Senior Software Engineer | Chennai, India

Feb 2014 - Jul 2016

- Built end-to-end ETL pipelines using SSIS for royalty calculation/distribution for APRA AMCOS, supporting complex rules and high-volume transactions.
- Developed automated test data generation tools, reducing QA cycle time by 20%.

CAREVOYANT - Software Engineer | Chennai, India

Dec 2011 - Jan 2014

- Developed HL7 parsers and SSIS pipelines to ingest EHR data and enable interoperability for US healthcare providers.
- Optimized SQL Server stored procedures and built WCF services supporting high-throughput billing and insurance workflows.

MEDALL HEALTHCARE PVT LTD - Software Engineer | Chennai, India

Sep 2010 - Nov 2011

- Built data marts, data warehouse, ETL (SSIS), and reporting (SSRS/SSAS) for forecasting and operational analytics.
- Developed SQL Server database objects (stored procedures, triggers, constraints, functions)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Analytics Engineer Associate (DP-600)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900)
- Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Computer Science | Anna University, Chennai, India (2010)

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Security:** Achieved 100% SFI compliance with measurable KPI closure across multiple orgs.
- **Cost:** Delivered \$390K+/year savings (\$240K/yr Databricks + \$150K/yr migration).
- **Scale:** Built platforms processing 50B+ events/month; delivered 40% performance improvement with zero-downtime migrations.
- **Leadership:** Managed teams up to 12 engineers, improving delivery outcomes through execution rigor, coaching, and technical governance.